



Figure 1: The OpenKM administration tab



Figure 2: The User List under the administration tab



Figure 3: The Role list under the administration tab



Figure 4: The Privileges list under the security tab

to fine-tune the tabs and buttons that are visible to different users (and then create users). Click the *Administration* tab at the upper right corner of the page; now click the *Profile* icon (in the middle of the buttons on the administration page, Figure 1). Here you can see the available profiles and add new ones. Depending on your requirements, you can create a new profile with only certain tabs and buttons visible, and just select that profile for new users, to ensure those users have restricted access to the system, as per your needs.

Now, let's create users. Click the *Users* button (next to the *Profile* button). This takes you to the *User List* (Figure 2). Click the *Add Users* button, fill out the form for *User Details*, selecting the appropriate profile for the user. You can also set roles for each user; logical grouping of users makes privilege management easier. Roles can be added on the *Roles* page (Figure 3), which is accessible from the *User* page.

users have access to a document, they can subscribe to it, and will get a notification whenever the document is changed.

OpenKM also provides version management of documents. Users can check out documents before changes, so that there is no confusion with someone else updating it simultaneously. Once an updated document is checked in, the new version is available to all. You can also lock a document so that no one else can modify it; this gives you better control of important documents.

Other features

We've discussed the basic features of OpenKM, but it has a lot more to offer. OpenKM integrates knowledge management with work-flow, mails, and chat too. Along with the work-flow management, you can add a process flow to the documents or folders. Actions like user input, i.e., decisions based on the input, can also be added to the work-flow. The OpenKM work-flow mechanism is based on JBoss jBPM, an extensible framework for process languages. The work-flow definition has to be made in XML. You can create the definition in JBoss and then deploy it with OpenKM. The steps to deploy the work-flow are listed at <http://goo.gl/lxPZzh>.

I hope this introduction to OpenKM gives you some insight into it, so that you can reap the benefits of this tool. Feedback and comments are most welcome. 

Using OpenKM

Now we come to the core functionality, which is knowledge management. You can upload documents in folders and share them with the users you want to, using the access-management mechanism discussed above. OpenKM also has a privilege-control mechanism for all documents; you can fine-tune the privileges each user has for a document. Just select the document, and go to the *Security* tab in the lower half of the page, where you can view privileges that users/roles have for this document, and change them. Once

Links

- [1] Official OpenKM site: <http://goo.gl/olciP>
- [2] OpenKM documentation: <http://goo.gl/VhUKP>
- [3] Deploying work-flow in OpenKM: <http://goo.gl/lxPZzh>
- [4] Work-flow process definition tutorial in JBoss: <http://goo.gl/1shH96>

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